

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report Portfolio

Field	Details
Name	Utkarsh Sawarn
Registration No.	25BET10017
Branch	CSE (EDUCATION TECHNOLOGY)
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Introduction

This report documents the work I completed as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy project. The scenario for this project was that I had been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador, and my job was to help my batchmates navigate the digital world more confidently. That meant doing five tasks — building an infographic, setting up my digital portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional email writing, and researching cybercrime.

Before starting this project, I thought I already knew most of what there was to know about using the internet. I have been online for years — I use social media, Google, YouTube, and various apps every single day. But going through each of these tasks made me realise that using technology and actually understanding it are two completely different things. There is a big gap between clicking around on a platform and knowing why it matters, what risks it carries, or how to present yourself professionally on it. This project helped me start closing that gap.

Each section below covers one task — what I made, what tool I used, and what I learned or found interesting. I have tried to write this honestly rather than just saying what sounds good.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I had to create a one-page visual resource explaining digital literacy to my batchmates — someone who uses digital tools every day but has probably never stopped to think about what that actually means.

I used Canva to build the infographic. I chose Canva because I had used it once before for a class presentation and already had a basic idea of how it worked. The design I came up with covered three main topics: what digital literacy actually means, safe internet practices, and professional online presence. I tried to keep the layout clean so it would not look cluttered — just short points with small icons and a simple colour scheme.

The most difficult part was deciding what to leave out. There is a lot you could say about digital literacy, and fitting it into one page without it looking like a wall of text took several tries. I kept removing things and simplifying sentences until it looked manageable.

What I found most interesting was making the section on professional online presence. It made me think about my own LinkedIn account, which I had set up once and basically forgotten about. I realised I had not really thought about how it looks to someone who does not know me, and whether what I had written there actually represented me accurately. That was an unexpected outcome of making a poster.

The exported infographic image and a brief description are saved in the task-1-presentation/ folder of my repository.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

This task was about setting up a professional digital presence across at least three platforms. I chose GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

I already had a LinkedIn account but it was nearly empty — just my name and the college name. For this task I filled in the Education section properly, added my expected graduation year, and wrote a short About section. It felt a little strange writing about myself in a formal way, but I understand why it matters. First impressions on LinkedIn are often based on just a few seconds of someone scrolling through your profile.

Setting up the GitHub profile README was the most technically new thing I did in this task. I had never used GitHub before this. Creating the special repository named after my username and writing a README inside it was simpler than I expected once I found the right steps. I wrote my name, branch, year, and a sentence about what I hope to learn during my degree. It is not much, but it is a start and I can keep building on it.

I also created a Kaggle account. I had heard of Kaggle before but only vaguely — I knew it was related to data science. Setting up the profile gave me a clearer picture of what it is actually for. Right now my profile is almost blank since I have not done any data science yet, but it is useful to have the account ready.

My plan over the next four years is to use GitHub as a proper portfolio of the code I write — not just lab assignments but actual projects. LinkedIn I want to keep updated as I do internships and get certifications. Kaggle I will probably start using more seriously in my third year when we get into machine learning. The point is that all three of these profiles are long-term investments, not just a one-time task.

Screenshots of all three profiles are saved in the task-2-portfolio/ folder.

Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

This task had two parts. The first was to explore a coding practice platform. The second was to build a Google Form for a Digital Literacy awareness quiz.

For the coding platform, I chose HackerRank. I completed the Solve Me First challenge in the Problem Solving section — it is one of the simplest challenges on the platform, basically just adding two numbers, but the point was to get familiar with how HackerRank works. The editor, the test cases, the submission format. Once I got through that first one, I also tried the Python Introduction challenge, which tested basic input and output in Python. I got both right, which gave me a small badge on my profile.

What surprised me about HackerRank was how structured the learning path is. There are specific tracks for different skills — Python, SQL, Problem Solving — and each one starts from scratch. For someone who has never coded seriously, it is actually a pretty accessible place to begin. I can see myself using it to practise consistently during the semester.

For Part B, I created a Google Form called 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' with five questions. I included one multiple choice question about identifying phishing emails, one short answer question asking students to name one safe internet practice they follow, and three other questions covering topics like strong password habits, professional email writing, and social media privacy settings. The form is linked in my README and the screenshot of the form and the linked Google Sheet are in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

Making the Google Form felt surprisingly practical. I actually think this quiz could be used for real — it covers things most first-year students probably have not thought carefully about.

Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

Email 1 – Requesting a Deadline Extension

Field	Content
Subject	Request for Assignment Submission Extension – Digital Literacy
To	Professor Kannan
Greeting	Respected sir,

I am writing to request an extension on the upcoming assignment submission for digital literacy, which is currently due on 31st march, 2026.

Over the past week I have been unwell and have not been able to complete the work to the standard I would like to submit. I have made progress, but I need a few more days to finish it properly. I am not asking for a long extension — just two or three additional days would be enough.

I understand that you may not always be able to grant extensions, and I completely respect that. I just wanted to be transparent about my situation rather than submitting something incomplete. Please let me know if there is anything you need from me, such as a medical certificate.

Thank you for your time and understanding.

Regards,

Utkarsh Sawarn

25BET10017

Email 2 – Internship Interest

Field	Content
Subject	Expression of Interest – Summer Internship Opportunity
To	HR/Internship Coordinator, Atlanssian
Greeting	Dear HR Team,

I am a first-year B.Tech student at VIT Bhopal University, currently studying CSE (EDUCATION TECHNOLOGY). I came across your company while researching organisations work in edu-tech sector, and I would very much like to be considered for a summer internship opportunity.

I am at an early stage of my degree but I am keen to gain practical exposure outside the classroom. I am a fast learner and I am comfortable with dsa and dbms. I am available for may and june starting from 13th may.

I have attached my resume and a brief portfolio link for your reference. I would be grateful for the opportunity to speak with you about any available openings. Please let me know if you need anything else from my end.

Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Utkarsh Sawarn

Utkarsh.25beT10017@gmail.com

Social Media Do's and Don'ts

Do's	Don'ts
Keep your LinkedIn profile updated with accurate information	Post anything you would not want a future employer to see
Use a professional profile photo on academic/career platforms	Share personal contact details publicly on social platforms
Think before you post — once it is online, it is hard to take back	Engage in or tolerate cyberbullying in any form

Follow and engage with accounts relevant to your field of study	Use the same weak password across multiple platforms
Enable privacy settings on personal social media accounts	Share unverified information or forward chain messages
Log out of shared devices after accessing your accounts	Accept connection requests from people you do not know without checking their profile

Communication Scenario

A scenario that comes to mind is a student sending a very casual, informal message to a professor asking for marks to be reconsidered — essentially saying 'sir my marks are less please check again' with no context, no subject line, and no proper greeting. The professor, receiving dozens of emails, has no idea which assignment this is about, what the student's name is, or what specific marks are being questioned.

The result was that the request was either ignored or handled very coldly — not because the student's concern was invalid, but because the communication gave the recipient nothing to work with. What the student could have done differently was write a short but structured email: a clear subject line mentioning the course and assignment, a polite greeting, two or three sentences explaining what they were asking about and why, and a respectful sign-off. Same request, completely different outcome.

This taught me that professional communication is not about using fancy words — it is about giving the reader enough context to actually respond helpfully.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

Case Study: Phishing Attack Targeting College Students

A student receives an email that appears to be from a well-known company — say, a technology firm or an educational platform. The email congratulates them on being shortlisted for a paid internship or scholarship. It looks professional: the logo is there, the language is formal, and the email address looks almost legitimate at first glance.

The email contains a link asking the student to fill in a form to confirm their selection. The form asks for name, college email, phone number, and — crucially — email login

credentials for verification purposes. The student, excited and under time pressure because the email mentions a 12-hour deadline, fills in the form and submits it.

Within hours, the student starts receiving password reset alerts and notices of suspicious login activity on their accounts. Their email has been compromised. If they used the same password on other accounts — which most people do — those are now vulnerable too.

The consequences can include loss of access to important academic accounts, personal data being sold or misused, and in some cases, financial fraud if banking apps are connected to the compromised email. The psychological impact — anxiety, loss of trust in online platforms — often lasts well beyond the incident itself.

What makes phishing so effective is not that people are careless — it is that the attacks are specifically designed to exploit the emotions of urgency and excitement. Legitimate companies never ask for login credentials over email. That is the single clearest warning sign.

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

The following checklist is designed specifically for college students in India:

- Always check the sender's full email address carefully before clicking any link — not just the display name.
- Never share your email or social media password with anyone, including people who claim to be from the college or a company.
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on your email, LinkedIn, GitHub, and any platform that offers it.
- Do not click links in unsolicited emails, even if they look official. Open a browser and go to the company's website directly.
- Use different passwords for different accounts. If remembering multiple passwords is hard, use a password manager like Bitwarden (free).
- For UPI and online payments: never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or QR code with anyone. Banks and payment apps never ask for this.

- If you receive a call asking you to transfer money or share an OTP for verification, hang up. Call the official number yourself to verify.
- Be careful about what personal information you make public on social media — your college, location, phone number, and daily routine can all be used to target you.
- Regularly check your bank and UPI transaction history and report anything unfamiliar immediately.
- If you experience or witness cybercrime, report it at cybercrime.gov.in or call Helpline 1930 (available 24x7).

Reflection

The part of this task that genuinely surprised me was how easy it is to get the technical details of a phishing attack right when you are the attacker. The logos, the formal tone, the sense of urgency — all of that takes maybe twenty minutes to put together. The gap between a fake email and a real one is much smaller than I had assumed.

What I will personally change as a result of this task is my password habits. I have been using the same two or three passwords for most of my accounts for years. After reading about how credential stuffing works — where attackers take one leaked password and try it on fifty other platforms — I know this is genuinely risky. I have already started setting up a password manager and changing the passwords for my most important accounts.

Conclusion

Going into this project, I thought of myself as reasonably good with technology. Coming out of it, I think I understand what that actually means more clearly. Using technology comfortably is a starting point, not an endpoint.

The five tasks covered different aspects of digital life — creativity, professional presence, collaboration, communication, and safety — and each one surfaced something I had not fully thought through before. The infographic task made me think about how I present information. The portfolio task made me take my online profiles seriously for the first time. The coding platform task showed me there are structured ways to build technical skills

outside the classroom. The email task reminded me that how I communicate affects how people respond to me. And the cybercrime task showed me that knowing about a threat and being prepared for it in a real situation are two different things.

I will keep updating my GitHub, LinkedIn, and other profiles as I go through my degree. This project gave me a starting point and a reason to take the whole idea of digital literacy seriously rather than treating it as just another first-year course.

References

The following tools, platforms, and resources were used or referenced during this project:

- Canva – canva.com (for Task 1 infographic)
- GitHub – github.com (for profile setup and repository management)
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com (for professional profile)
- Kaggle – kaggle.com (for data science portfolio)
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com (for coding practice)
- Google Forms & Google Sheets – forms.google.com (for quiz creation)
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in (for Task 5 reference)
- CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) – cert-in.org.in
- Bitwarden – bitwarden.com (referenced as a free password manager)